

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

CONTENT

- Let's Start! • Let's Explore! • Let's Practice! • Extension Activity • Target Words • Learning Points



Let's Start!

Why did you cancel?



Learning Outcome

Describe ways of solving problems and getting things done in written and spoken situations and in work and social contexts.

Can Do Statements

- I can talk about emotions, personal qualities and behavior.
- I can talk about things that need to be done.
- I can talk about solving problems.

Ask your partner:

- What kind of events do you enjoy attending?
- Have you ever organized an event? What kind?
- Have you ever backed out of going to an event? Why?





Let's Explore!

Peter **backed out*** on plans. Can you believe he canceled?

* To "back out" means to withdraw from a previous commitment.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

- Sally:** Let's see. What do I need to do for this weekend? My blog article needs to be wrapped up. My Visa card needs to be paid off. The floors need washing. The carpet needs vacuuming. Hmm. What else? My clothes need to be washed and then ...
- Sally:** Hello?
- Vanessa:** Hi, Sally. It's Vanessa. I'm furious right now. I want to kill Peter!
- Sally:** Why? What happened?
- Vanessa:** He canceled on the axe throwing. I'm so mad!
- Sally:** No! What did he say?
- Vanessa:** Nothing. He texted me. He came up with some lame excuse. He said that his boss had him doing some emergency project where he had to write a press release. I phoned him back, but he didn't answer, so I left a message.
- Sally:** Well, maybe that's true. Maybe he is tied up at his new job.
- Vanessa:** How long does that take to write a stupid press release? He is just trying to get out of it. Also, I am having trouble getting other people to attend. I had the axe-throwing club sign us up yesterday, so I can't back out. Sally, I'm at the end of my rope with Peter. Can I get you to call him? Maybe you can get him to change his mind.
- Sally:** Sure. I'll talk to him. I can get him to come out. I think I can also get some people I know to take part as well.
- Vanessa:** Really? Oh. That's good news.
- Sally:** Yeah, I talked to them today and they sounded intrigued.
- Vanessa:** This is really starting to stress me out.





Let's Practice!

Why is Vanessa disturbed?

Instructions: Read the dialogue on page 2 again. Select the correct answer for each case. Practice reading the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

1. Peter came up with a lame excuse.

He has ...

- ☐ to attend a press event.
- ☐ to write a press release.
- ☐ to write a press excuse.
- ☐ other plans.
- ☐ no excuse.

3. Why did Vanessa ask Sally to call Peter?

- ☐ Because she is sad
- ☐ Because she is mad at him
- ☐ Because she is jealous of him
- ☐ Because she loves him
- ☐ Because her phone isn't working

2. Who's angry?

- ☐ Sally
- ☐ Peter
- ☐ Vanessa
- ☐ David
- ☐ John



Let's Practice!

Sally is so busy!

Instructions: Choose words from the box to correctly complete the sentences. Read the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor. Model a conversation with a partner using the sentences. Switch roles.

Words Bank

- vacuuming
- washing
- wrapped up
- wrap up
- cleaning
- paid up
- take part
- washed
- paid off
- take up

1. My blog article needs to be _____.

2. My Visa card needs to be _____.

3. The floor needs _____. The carpet needs _____.

4. Hmm. What else? My clothes need to be _____ and then ...

5. I think I can also get some people I know to _____ as well.





Extension Activity

Plan a party with friends!

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Brainstorm different kinds of parties and party activities.
- With a partner, choose a party or an activity and make a plan and a schedule.
- Write down the things do you need to do beforehand.
- Use need + passive ing, and need + passive to describe all the things that need to be done.
- Use expressions with have/get to say how to do things.
- Plan your guest list of friends to invite.
- Pick five friends and explain to your partner why they are fun to have at a party.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I brainstorm about different parties and party activities.

☐ ☐

I use 'need + passive ing' and 'need + passive to' to discuss things that need to be done before the party.

☐ ☐

I express activities other people have to get or have.

☐ ☐

I discuss friends and explain why they would be good guests.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- **tied up** (adjective): occupied or engaged
e.g. Maybe he is tied up at his new job.
- **press release** (noun): a statement or announcement about something newsworthy that is released to the press or media
e.g. He had to write a press release.
- **to get out** (verb): to avoid doing something that you do not want to do, or to escape responsibility
e.g. He is just trying to get out of it.
- **to back out** (verb): to decide not to do something that you had said you would do
e.g. I can't back out now.
- **intrigued** (adjective): something or someone that captures your attention and inspires curiosity
e.g. I was intrigued by their story.
- **at the end of my rope** (expression): out of energy or patience
e.g. I'm at the end of my rope with Peter.





Learning Points

Need + Passive Infinitive and Need +Verb+ing

You can use *need* + *passive infinitive* and *need* + *verb+ing* to talk about things that need to be done.

You use these structures to focus on the **thing** that needs doing, not the person who is doing it.

Subject + Need + Passive Infinitive

*My blog article **needs to be wrapped up**.*

The subject of the sentence is the thing that needs doing.

Subject + Need + Verb + ing

*The floor **needs washing**.*

When you use *need* with a gerund (v-ing), it has a passive meaning.

Examples:

- *My blog article **needs to be wrapped up**.*
- *My Visa card **needs to be paid off**.*
- *The floors **need washing**, and the carpet **needs vacuuming**.*
- *My clothes **need to be washed**.*





Learning Points

The Causative - Get/Have - Solving Problems

You use a *causative* verb when you want to talk about something that someone else did for you or for another person. It means that the subject caused the action to happen, but didn't do it themselves.

You use the causative verbs get/have when you want to make it clear that the subject paid, asked, or persuaded the other person to do something.

For example:

*My boss **had me do** an emergency project.*

In this sentence the boss asks or persuades you to do an emergency project.

The structure of the causative is:

have + object + verb

*I **had the axe-throwing club sign us up** yesterday.*

or

Subject + get + object + Infinitive

*Maybe you can **get him to change** his mind.*

You use *get* to convey the idea that you need to persuade someone to do something. *Have* is a little more neutral and implies that you give someone the responsibility to do something.

Examples:

- *He said that his boss had him doing some emergency project where he had to write a press release.*
- *I am having trouble getting other people to attend.*
- *I had the axe-throwing club sign us up yesterday, so I can't back out now.*
- *I can get him to come out.*
- *I think I can also get some people I know to take part as well.*

